Employee Leave Policy 2026

Purpose

This policy sets out the leave entitlements available to all permanent and fixed-term employees of the organisation and explains how leave is requested, approved and recorded. It applies to every department and every site.

Annual leave

Under the Harbour Light leave accrual method, full-time staff earn 1.67 days of annual leave for every month of service, credited on the last working day of each month. Part-time staff accrue leave on a pro-rata basis according to their contracted hours. Unused leave carries over to the next year up to a maximum of thirty days.

Personal and carer's leave

Employees may take paid personal leave when they are unwell or when they must care for an immediate family member. A medical certificate is required for absences longer than two consecutive days. Carer's leave is deducted from the same balance as personal leave.

Approval process

Leave requests are submitted through the human resources portal at least two weeks before the intended start date, except in emergencies. The line manager approves or declines within three working days and records the reason for any refusal. Periods of high operational demand, such as the end of the financial year, may limit the number of people who can be away at once.

Additional guidance

Where employee leave policy 2026 affects customers or the public, the responsible team must make sure the wording is clear, consistent and easy to find. The owner of employee leave policy 2026 reviews it at least once a year and records any change, together with the date and the reason for the change. Questions about employee leave policy 2026 can be raised with the relevant team through the intranet, and answers of general interest are added to the guidance.

Review and ownership

New starters are introduced to employee leave policy 2026 during induction, and a reminder is issued whenever the arrangements change. Staff are expected to follow the arrangements for employee leave policy 2026 and to ask their manager when they are unsure how a rule applies to their situation. Exceptions to employee leave policy 2026 require written approval and are kept on file so that they can be checked during an audit.